

Mary, Star of the Sea 2026-2027

6th Grade Band Syllabus

Mrs. Deeann Nishibun

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Course Outline/Objectives

Throughout the school year, students will learn the value of music by understanding the elements of music: rhythm, dynamics, melody, harmony, tone color, and texture. By the end of the school year, all students will demonstrate proper posture, playing position, intonation, fingerings, style, balance and blending, articulation, and phrasing. Students will use this knowledge and the fundamentals of their instrument to actively listen, express themselves, and engage through music. Music Education allows students to develop a love of music that will carry on for the rest of their lives.

Student Behavior

Living Our NUI Mission

At MSOS, we believe that living our NUI mission—**Nurturing each other, Uniting as a community, and Inspiring excellence**—guides how we learn and grow together.

Students are expected to:

- Respect all people and property in the classroom at all times.
- Participate in all activities and come prepared for every class.
- Try their best
- Follow student code of conduct per the handbook

If expectations are not met, we will take steps to help students reflect and improve.

Steps for Growth: Students may receive up to three verbal reminders, take time during recess or lunch to refocus, connect with parents through email or phone, participate in a Saturday session for improvement, or meet with the principal to create a positive plan moving forward.

Required Materials

All Students are required to have in their possession at every class session:

- Essential Elements Method **Book 1**
- Assigned Instrument (Percussionists will bring book and own drumsticks to class)
- Instrument Accessories (3 extra reeds, valve oil, mouthpiece, cork grease, neck strap, slide cream, cleaning cloth, polishing cloth)

Failure to bring the required materials will result in reduced participation points for that class.

Grading Policy

Students will earn grades through class participation, testing, and weekly at-home practice. Students needing extra help may schedule a meeting during recess or lunch recess. All assignments will be posted and assigned on Google Classroom- 6th Band. All grades will be posted in Beehively, which includes late and missing assignments.

*Students and parents should check **Google Classroom** and **Beehively** frequently for all assignments and current grades.

Class Participation: 50%

- Bring instrument and book to every class
- Bring all other required materials
- Following rules and directions
- Active participation

Testing: 30%

- Playing and written tests

Practice Logs: 20%

- Weekly practice is necessary to review/remember fingerings and concepts learned during class. Practicing several times a week with shorter sessions is

recommended to achieve the 60-minute weekly total and maximize retention.

Example: 4x a week (M, W, F, Sa) for 15 minutes each session

- The log must include a parent/guardian signature to receive full credit
- **Due by 5:00 pm every Friday on Google Classroom**
- Late logs will only receive partial credit
- Logs will **NOT** be accepted 7 days past the due date

Contact Information:

dnishibun@starofthesea.org

***Note: Emails are read/replied to during regular school hours*

